

September

28

Also on this day

1889 The length of a metre was officially established by the General Conference on Weights and Measures (CGPM) in France.

2008 The Formula One motorsport race hosted its first-ever night race at the Singapore Grand Prix.

2018 The melting of ice caps in the Arctic Ocean made it possible for a container ship, the *Venta Maersk*, to pass through Arctic waters for the first time.



1924

World flight

Four US Army Air Service aircraft returned to Seattle, USA, after completing the first flight around the globe.

The mission was accomplished in 175 days, with the crew braving extreme weather conditions along the way.

Born this day

551 BCE Confucius, Chinese philosopher. A celebrated thinker, he set up schools to teach young scholars, and his teachings came to be known as Confucianism.

1538

Fierce warrior

At the Battle of Preveza, Turkish admiral Hayreddin Barbarossa commanded a victorious fleet, defending the Ottoman Empire against Christian forces. Also known as Redbeard, he was feared throughout the Mediterranean.



1928

Making antibiotics

When Scottish scientist Alexander Fleming noticed a type of mould killing bacteria in a Petri dish, he realized he could use it for medical purposes. He called the substance it produced "penicillin", which became the first antibiotic.